

Bryson Stott — Approach Change Read

2026 season through Aug 13 · Phillies Offense · UC #34 / uc-pos-010 / dp_uc33

DATA WINDOW: pos pitch log, 2015 → **2026-08-13**. Regular season + postseason (game_type not in S/E). All 2026 figures are **as-of 8/13 and August is a partial month**. Receipts: out/dp_uc33_*.csv (5 files + 5 figures). Verification: dp_uc33_verification.py , **86/86 PASS**, recomputed from inline masks with no import of the build kernel. Any line below the 50-PA floor is flagged and is directional only. **Manual carry-ins (not derivable from the pitch log): none.**

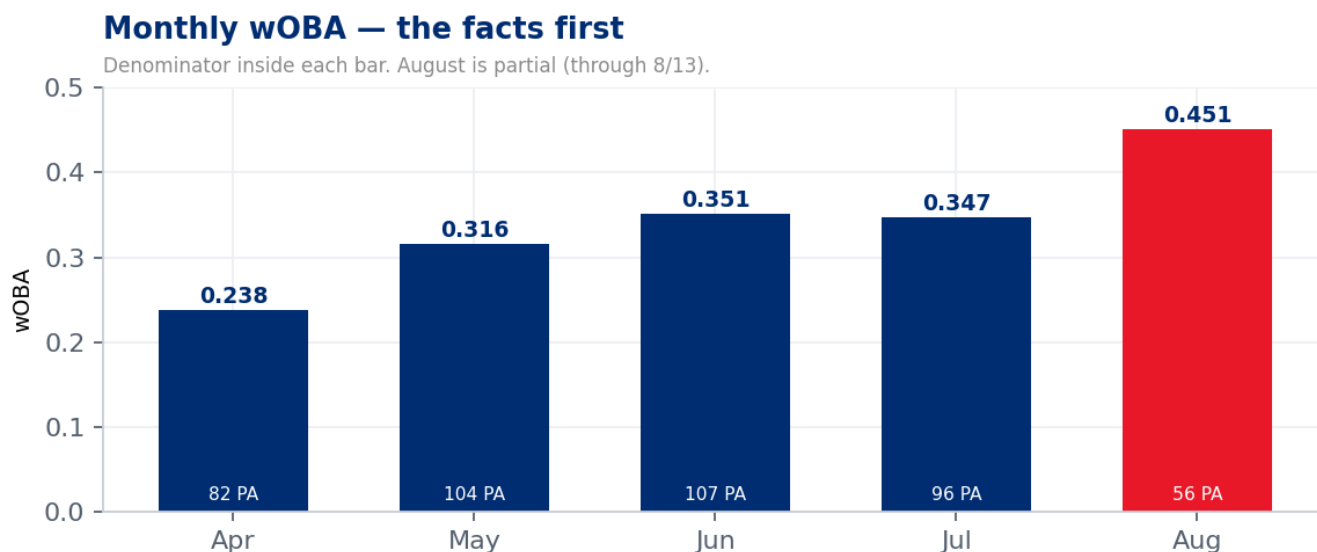
The short version

Bryson Stott's results did improve steadily after a bad April, and he did change his approach. **Both halves of that sentence verify.** But the read is incomplete without a third fact the approach panel alone will not show you: **pitchers changed too, and more sharply than he did.**

His first-pitch strike rate fell from **67.1% in April to 41.1% in August** — a 26-point collapse in how often opponents come at him with a strike. Over the same window his chase rate fell from 32.7% to **21.5%**. Those two moves are not independent, and this data product cannot tell you which one caused the other.

What it *can* tell you is that the improvement is **not** an outcome-only artifact. The approach metrics moved, in the right direction, by margins that dwarf their month-to-month noise.

1 · The facts first — how the results actually moved



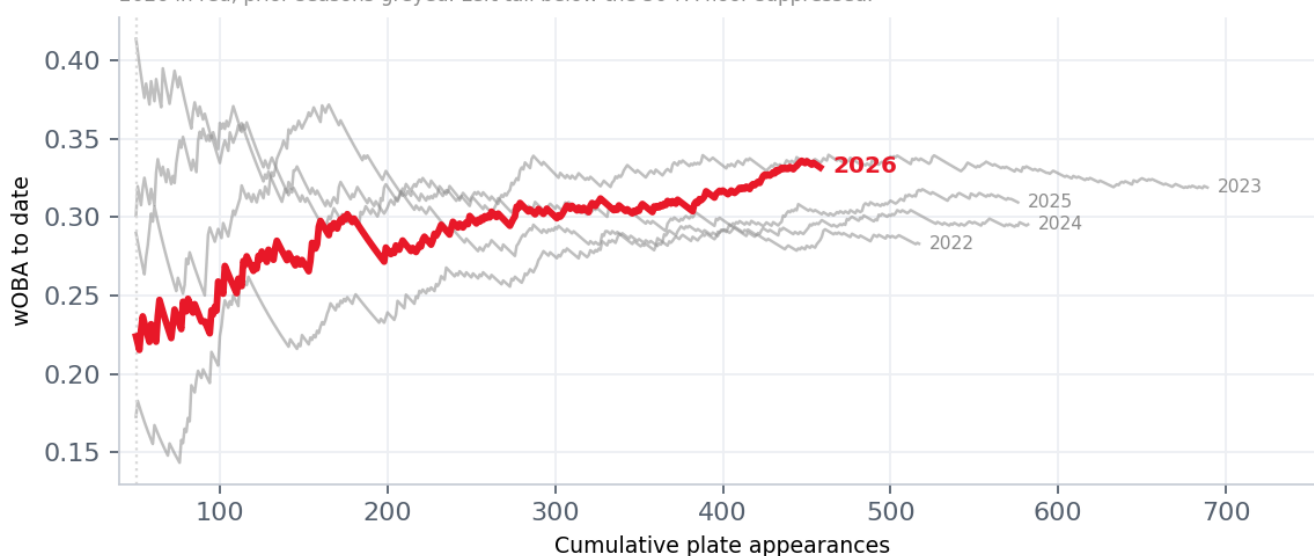
Month	PA	BA	OBP	SLG	OPS	wOBA
March	13	0.250	0.308	0.250	0.558	0.259
April	82	0.200	0.250	0.280	0.530	0.238
May	104	0.227	0.269	0.474	0.743	0.316
June	107	0.287	0.374	0.415	0.789	0.351
July	96	0.287	0.344	0.460	0.804	0.347
August*	56	0.381	0.527	0.476	1.003	0.451

* August is a partial month (through 8/13). March is 13 PA — **below the 50-PA floor, shown for completeness and not to be interpreted.**

The "grown steadily" claim **holds, with one correction**: the climb is not monotonic. June (.351) and July (.347) are effectively flat, so the shape is a **step up in May, a plateau through July, then a second step in August** — not a smooth ramp. That distinction matters for coaching: two step changes invite the question *what changed at each step*, which a smooth ramp does not.

Rolling wOBA by cumulative PA

2026 in red, prior seasons greyed. Left tail below the 50-PA floor suppressed.

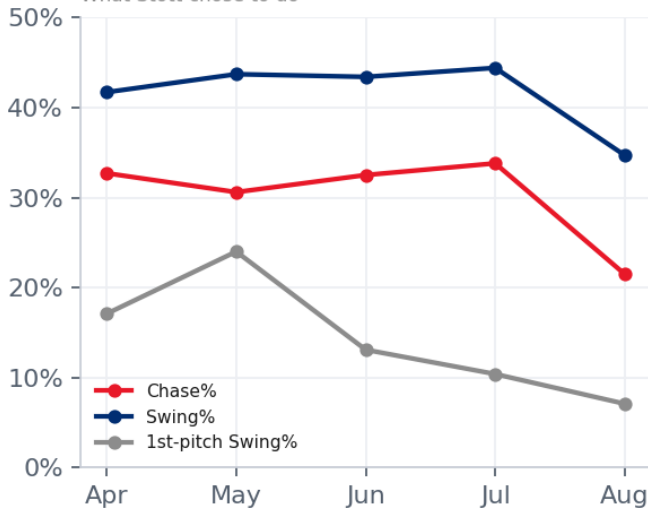


Indexed to cumulative plate appearances rather than calendar months, 2026 is the **lowest of Stott's five seasons through roughly 150 PA and the highest of them by PA 450**. No prior season traces that path. The calendar-month view compresses this into five bars; the rolling view shows it is one continuous climb rather than five separate months.

2 · Did he change his approach? Yes — and it is concentrated in August

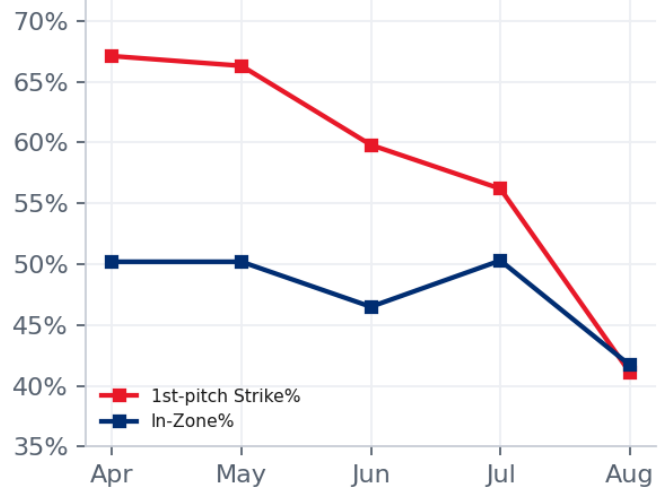
HITTER approach

What Stott chose to do



PITCHER intent

What pitchers chose to do to him



Hitter approach — what Stott chose to do

Month	Swing%	1st-Pitch Swing%	Chase%	Whiff%	OOZ Whiff%
March	46.2%	0.0%	48.3%	12.5%	21.4%
April	41.7%	17.1%	32.7%	19.5%	38.0%
May	43.7%	24.0%	30.6%	16.6%	28.6%
June	43.4%	13.1%	32.5%	17.8%	25.9%
July	44.4%	10.4%	33.8%	25.9%	45.5%
August*	34.7%	7.1%	21.5%	12.8%	23.5%

Pitcher intent — what pitchers chose to do to him

Month	1st-Pitch Strike%	In-Zone%	Pitches/PA
March	53.8%	44.2%	4.00
April	67.1%	50.2%	3.74
May	66.3%	50.2%	3.98
June	59.8%	46.5%	4.35
July	56.2%	50.3%	4.08
August*	41.1%	41.7%	4.84

These are two different panels on purpose. First-Pitch Strike% and In-Zone% describe the *opponent's* execution, not Stott's behaviour. Reading them as hitter metrics is the single easiest way to misinterpret this report.

The discriminating test. The question posed at intake was: "*He chased, but he did not whiff. Or did he just not chase anymore?*" Four outcomes were possible, and they are separable:

Branch	Chase%	OOZ Whiff%	Reading	Verdict
H1	flat	↓	Same aggression, better contact	partial
H2	↓	flat	Genuine decision change	partial
H3	↓	↓	Both moved	this one
H4	flat	flat	Pitchers missed; Stott unchanged	rejected

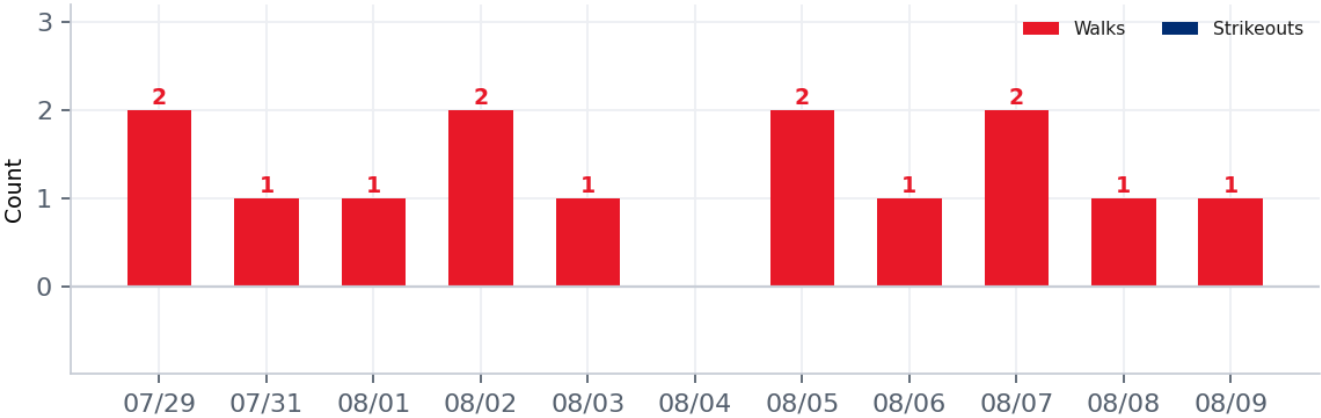
Chase fell **33.8% → 21.5%** from July to August. Out-of-zone whiff rate fell **45.5% → 23.5%** over the same span. **Both moved, and chase moved on a larger base** — he is seeing 34 out-of-zone swings a month now against 66–81 earlier in the season. The narrative claim "*he does not expand, he does not chase*" is **supported by the data**.

"*He takes the first pitch all the time*" is also supported, and it is the sharpest single number in the report: **first-pitch swing rate 24.0% in May → 7.1% in August**.

3 · The headline — 14 walks between strikeouts

14 walks, zero strikeouts — 11 games, Jul 29 → Aug 9

Game grain: counts only. 46 PA total sits below every rate floor.



Game	PA	BB	K	H
Jul 29	4	2	0	1
Jul 31	4	1	0	0
Aug 01	4	1	0	1
Aug 02	3	2	0	0
Aug 03	4	1	0	1
Aug 04	4	0	0	2
Aug 05	4	2	0	1
Aug 06	4	1	0	2
Aug 07	4	2	0	0
Aug 08	5	1	0	2
Aug 09	6	1	0	2
Total	46	14	0	12

The claim verifies exactly. 14 walks, zero strikeouts, across 11 games from July 29 to August 9 — 46 plate appearances. It is the longest such run of Stott's career by a wide margin:

Season	Longest walk run between strikeouts	Games
2022	8	7
2023	3	3
2024	9	5
2025	4	3
2026	14	11

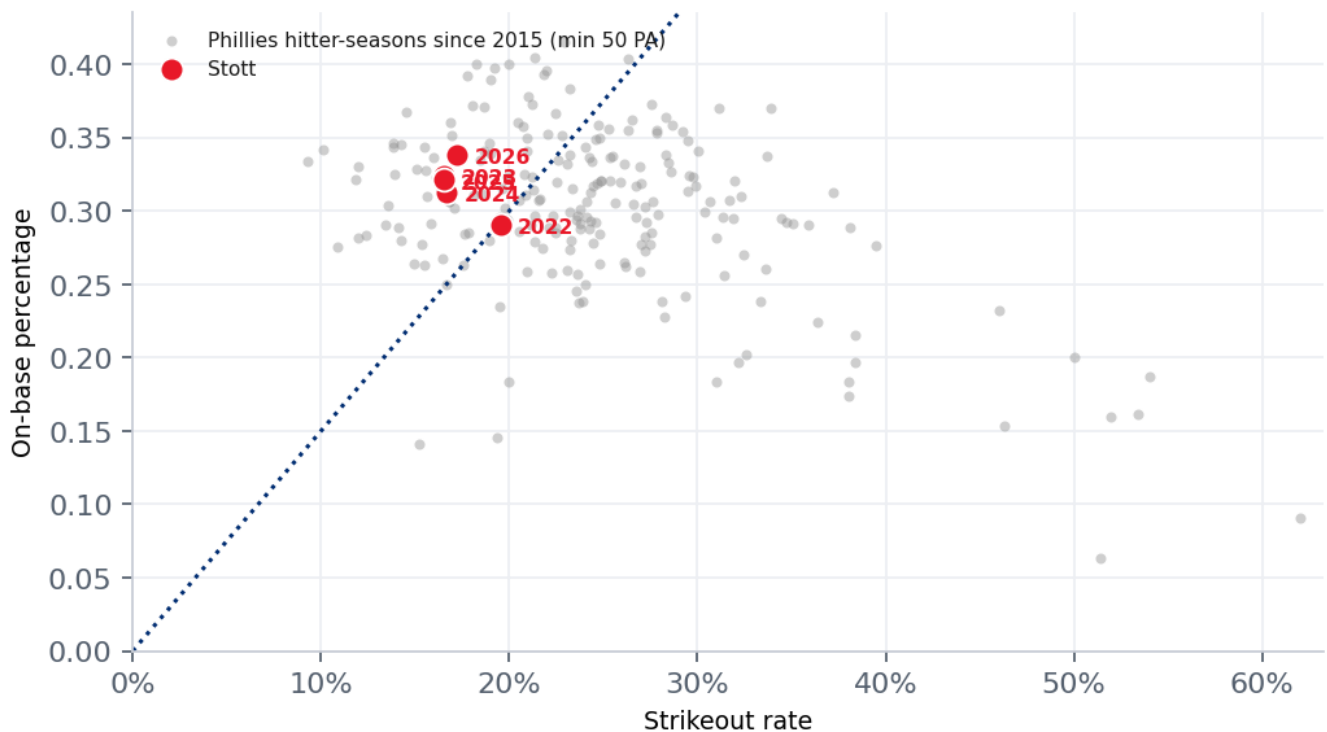
⚠ Read this window as an illustration, not as evidence. It was selected *because* it contains 14 walks and no strikeouts, so its walk rate and strikeout rate are guaranteed to be extraordinary — they are the selection criterion. The **monthly** panels in §2 are the inferential evidence; this section is the story. Metrics not used in the selection — chase rate, first-pitch swing rate, out-of-zone whiff rate — carry information here. BB% and K% do not.

4 · Context — is this who he is, or is this new?

OBP:K = 3:2

OBP as a function of K% — Stott against his own franchise

A constant OBP:K ratio is a ray from the origin. Above the dotted line beats 3:2.



Season	PA	BB%	K%	BB/K	OBP	OBP:K
2022	517	8.3%	19.5%	0.426	0.291	1.49
2023	689	6.0%	16.5%	0.360	0.324	1.96
2024	582	9.1%	16.7%	0.546	0.313	1.88
2025	576	9.2%	16.5%	0.558	0.321	1.95
2026	458	9.6%	17.2%	0.557	0.338	1.96

Against **217 Phillies hitter-seasons since 2015** (98 players, minimum 50 PA), Stott's career OBP:K ratio of **1.85** sits at the **83rd percentile**; the pool median is 1.29. His BB/K of 0.49 is at the **83rd percentile** against a 0.32 median.

The DPO's stated 3:2 is understated. Stott has run closer to **1.85:1**, and he has cleared the 3:2 line in every season since 2022. On the chart, a constant OBP:K ratio is a **ray from the origin** — every point above the dotted line beats 3:2. All five of his seasons are above it.

Month	PA	BB%	K%	BB/K
March	13	7.7%	15.4%	0.500
April	82	4.9%	19.5%	0.250
May	104	5.8%	14.4%	0.400
June	107	11.2%	18.7%	0.600
July	96	8.3%	22.9%	0.364
August*	56	23.2%	7.1%	3.250

August's **BB/K of 3.25** — 13 walks to 4 strikeouts — is not a variation on his baseline. It is roughly six times his career rate.

5 · What a coach should and should not conclude

Supported:

- The approach change is real, measurable, and concentrated in August.
- It is a **swing-decision** change first — chase and first-pitch swing rate moved most.
- It is consistent with, but larger than, an established career-long strength.

Not supported — and the reason to be careful:

- **That Stott caused the improvement by himself.** First-pitch strike rate fell 26 points and in-zone rate fell 8. Pitchers are working around him. A hitter who is thrown fewer strikes will chase less and walk more *without changing anything*. Chase rate is conditioned on out-of-zone pitches, so it is not a pure mix artifact — but the feedback loop is real and this data product cannot break it.
- **That it will hold.** August is 56 PA, partial, and above his career line by a margin no 56-PA sample can confirm.
- **Opponent quality and platoon mix are uncontrolled.** No adjustment was made for who he faced.

The one thing worth acting on: the first-pitch behaviour. Taking 93% of first pitches while seeing first-pitch strikes only 41% of the time is a coherent, repeatable plan, and it is the part of this that is entirely within Stott's control. If any single element deserves reinforcement, it is that one.

6 • Governance

Use case	uc-pos-010-stott-approach-change-001 · value stream pos
Verification	dp_uc33_verification.py — 86 PASS / 0 FAIL
Grain	player_name × game_year × month ; drill to game_pk ; context at player_name × game_year
Floors	50 PA (inherited standard), 40 BIP for EV90. Below-floor rows flagged, never dropped
New KPIs	AP-2 swing_rate , AP-3 srfp , AP-6 rolling wOBA, AP-9 discipline_ratio , AP-10 walks_between_ks — all provisional pending DPO ratification
Inherited	fpsr (approved cde.fpsr), SWINGS/WHIFFS lists, PA definition, wOBA constants
Open items	6 — see 00_dpo_orchestration_record.md

Three defects were found in the governed kernel during this build — whiff_rate , hard_hit_rate and fpsr all inner-merge their numerator and **silently drop groups where the numerator is zero**. They are reported in 05_quality_certification.md , not patched in place.